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SI 201

Reflection

I think the system for short term rentals in San Francisco is decent but not really strong enough. It looks good on paper because hosts are supposed to register and show policy numbers, but in reality it does not always work how it should. When we did this project, we saw that some listings had missing or invalid policy numbers. That shows the system is not being checked closely enough. It kind of depends too much on hosts doing the right thing and Airbnb actually enforcing it.

If I could change something, I think Airbnb should be required to verify every policy number with the city before letting a listing go live. Right now it feels like people can just put anything and it might still get through. If there was automatic checking, it would make the system way more reliable and harder to get around.

For web scraping, one big thing to think about is whether the data is actually meant to be used that way. Just because something is public does not always mean it is fair game. There are also laws like the Computer Fraud and Abuse Act that can make scraping illegal if it goes against a website's rules. I think intent matters too. Using data for a project like this feels fine, but using it to take advantage of people is different.

There are also ethical issues with scraping. One important guideline is to respect people's privacy. Even if data is public, you should not use it in a way that could harm someone. Another guideline is being honest about what you are doing with the data. If you are collecting

information, there should be a clear reason for it and it should not be misleading. Overall, scraping can be useful, but it should be done carefully and not just because you can.